STRETCHKIT

Drum sample map · natural drum time-stretch · step sequencer

User Manual & Installation Guide

Version 0.1.0 · macOS & Windows · AU / VST3 / Standalone



Made by

@sxdrv.mp3

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01 About StretchKit

StretchKit is a free drum instrument plugin. It scans your drum sample folders, sorts every one-shot by how it sounds and lays them out on a map, so similar sounds sit next to each other. Each of its eight tracks can stretch its sample to any length from 25% to 400% of the original — keeping the attack untouched so drums stay punchy — and a step sequencer plays it all in time with your DAW.

- **Sample map** — automatic sorting into Kick, Snare, Clap, Hat, Cymbal, Tom, Perc and Other, with similar sounds grouped together. Click and drag to hear every sound you pass.
- **Similarity bar** — the 24 sounds closest to the one you picked, with history and favourites.
- **Drum time-stretch** — Hybrid mode keeps the transient sample-for-sample and stretches only the tail (Rubber Band R3).
- **Step sequencer** — 8 tracks, 8/16/32 steps, accents, swing, choke, synced to your DAW.
- **Drag MIDI** — drag your pattern straight into the DAW as a MIDI clip.
- **5 skins** — PS2 Night, Y2K Chrome, Digicore, Mix and Liquid Chrome.

Requirements

	macOS	Windows
System	macOS 10.13 or later, Apple Silicon or Intel	Windows 10 / 11, 64-bit
Formats	AU, VST3, Standalone	VST3, Standalone
Host	Logic Pro, GarageBand, Ableton Live, FL Studio, Cubase, Bitwig, Reaper, Studio One...	Any 64-bit VST3 host

> **Why no VST2?** Steinberg stopped issuing VST2 licences in 2018, so new plugins can't be released as VST2. Every current DAW loads VST3 (and Logic / GarageBand use AU).

02 Download

All files are on the releases page. Download only what you need:

https://github.com/edwina9195/stretchkit/releases/latest

File	What it is
StretchKit-mac-AU.zip	macOS Audio Unit — Logic Pro, GarageBand
StretchKit-mac-VST3.zip	macOS VST3 — Ableton, FL Studio, Cubase, Bitwig, Reaper...
StretchKit-mac-Standalone.zip	macOS app that runs without a DAW
StretchKit-win-VST3.zip	Windows VST3 plugin
StretchKit-win-Standalone.zip	Windows app that runs without a DAW

03 Install on macOS

1. Double-click the zip file(s) you downloaded to unzip them.
2. In Finder choose **Go › Go to Folder...** and paste the folder path for your format:

Format	Put this	Into this folder
AU	StretchKit.component	~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/
VST3	StretchKit.vst3	~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/
Standalone	StretchKit.app	/Applications/

3. StretchKit is free and not signed through Apple's paid developer programme, so macOS blocks files downloaded from the internet. Open **Terminal** (Applications › Utilities) and run the lines for the formats you installed — this only removes the download flag from these files:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/StretchKit.component
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/StretchKit.vst3
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/StretchKit.app
```

4. Restart your DAW. If Logic Pro still doesn't list it, run the line below and restart Logic:

```
killall -9 AudioComponentRegistrar
```

04 Install on Windows

1. Right-click the downloaded zip and choose **Extract All...**
2. Copy the **StretchKit.vst3** folder into `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\` (click **Continue** if Windows asks for administrator permission).
3. Standalone: put **StretchKit.exe** anywhere you like. If SmartScreen says “Windows protected your PC”, click **More info › Run anyway** (the app is unsigned, not unsafe).
4. Restart your DAW and let it scan for new plugins.

> No extra runtimes are needed — the plugin includes everything it uses.

05 Find it in your DAW

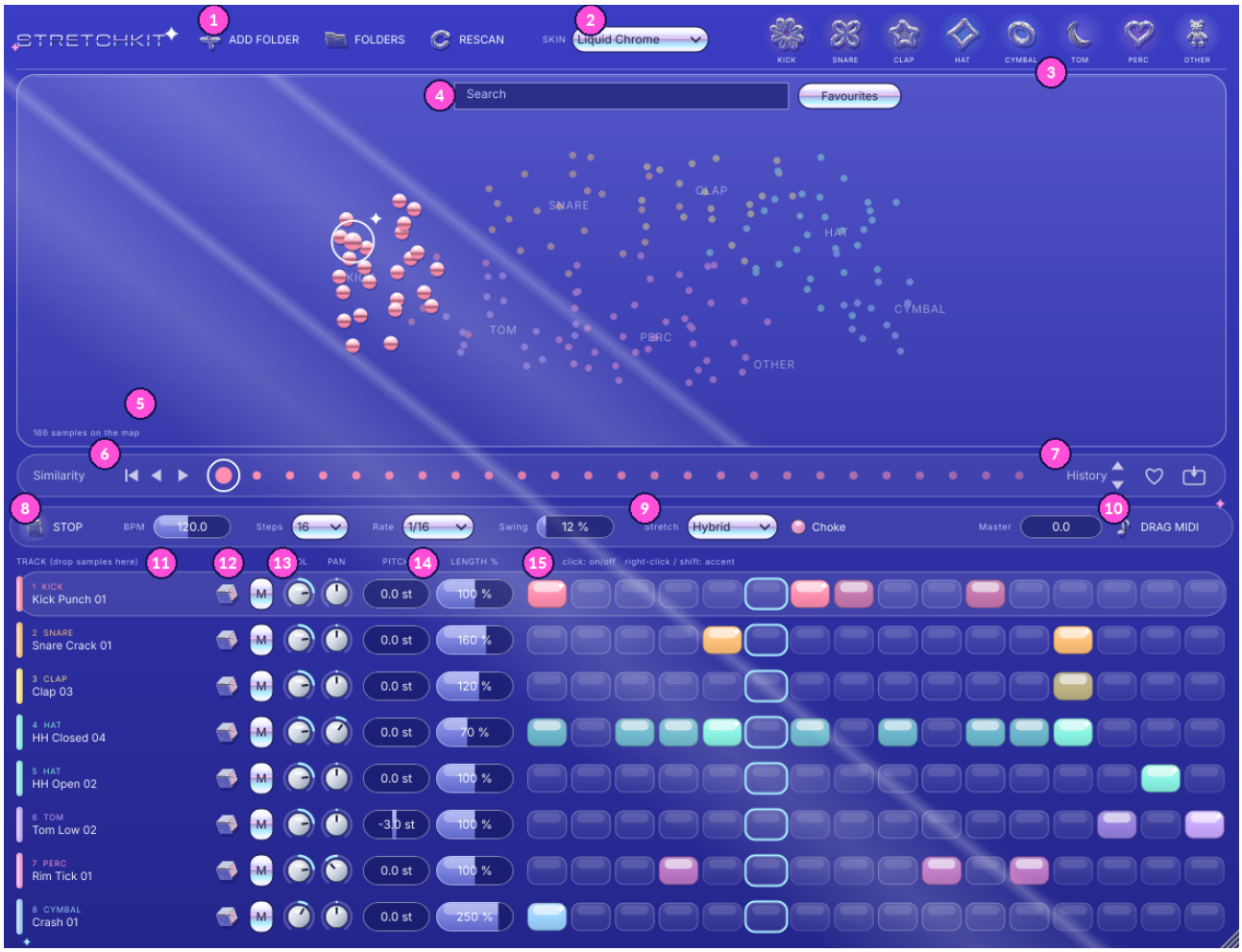
StretchKit is an **instrument**: put it on a MIDI / instrument track. It is listed under the maker **sxdrv.mp3**. Menu names can differ slightly between DAW versions.

DAW	What to do
Ableton Live	Settings › Plug-Ins: turn on Use VST3 Plug-in System Folders (Mac: also Use Audio Units), then **Rescan**. Find it under Plug-Ins › sxdrv.mp3.
FL Studio	Options › Manage plugins › **Find installed plugins**, then add it from the Channel Rack (+).
Logic Pro / GarageBand	Uses the AU version. Instrument slot › AU Instruments › sxdrv.mp3 › StretchKit. If missing: Settings › Plug-in Manager › Reset & Rescan Selection.
Cubase / Nuendo	Scans on start-up. Check Studio › VST Plug-in Manager if it doesn't show.
Bitwig Studio	Settings › Locations: make sure VST3 is enabled, then rescan.
Reaper	Options › Preferences › Plug-ins › VST › **Re-scan**.
Studio One	Scans on start-up. Options › Locations › VST Plug-ins to check the folder list.

06 Quick start

1. Load StretchKit on an instrument track.
2. Click **Add Folder** and choose the folder with your drum samples. The map fills in while it scans.
3. On first use, StretchKit loads a random starter kit from your library onto the 8 tracks.
4. Press **Play** in your DAW (or StretchKit's own Play button) — the starter pattern plays.
5. Click and drag across the map to hear sounds; keep dragging out of the map onto a track to load the last one.
6. Drag **LENGTH %** on a track and let go — the track plays its new, stretched sound. Click a track name to hear it again.

07 The screen at a glance



1 Add Folder / Folders / Rescan — manage the folders that are scanned

2 Skin — switch the look (remembered for next time)

3 Category filters — show or hide each kind of sound on the map

4 Search / Favourites — filter the map by name or by hearts

5 Sample map — every one-shot as a dot; scan progress and count bottom-left

6 Similarity bar — the picked sound and its 24 closest sounds

7 History, heart, load to the selected track

8 Play / Stop — runs the sequencer when the DAW is stopped

9 Stretch mode — Hybrid, Smooth or Tape

10 Drag MIDI — drag the pattern into your DAW

11 Track — drop samples here; click to select and hear the track's own sound

12 Rnd (dice) — swap for a similar sound; M — mute

13 VOL / PAN

14 PITCH / LENGTH % — tuning and time-stretch

15 Steps — the pattern for this track

08 Sample map

Adding folders. Click **Add Folder** and pick a folder; sub-folders are included. Use **Folders** to remove one and **Rescan** after adding new files. WAV, AIFF, FLAC and OGG files up to 10 seconds long are included (longer files are treated as loops and skipped).

You only scan once. Folders and results are saved on your computer and shared by every StretchKit you open: the next time, the map appears straight away with nothing to load. A large library is analysed on several CPU cores and its progress is saved as it goes — if you close the plugin or the DAW in the middle, the scan carries on by itself the next time StretchKit opens, skipping everything already done. Rescan only looks at new or changed files.

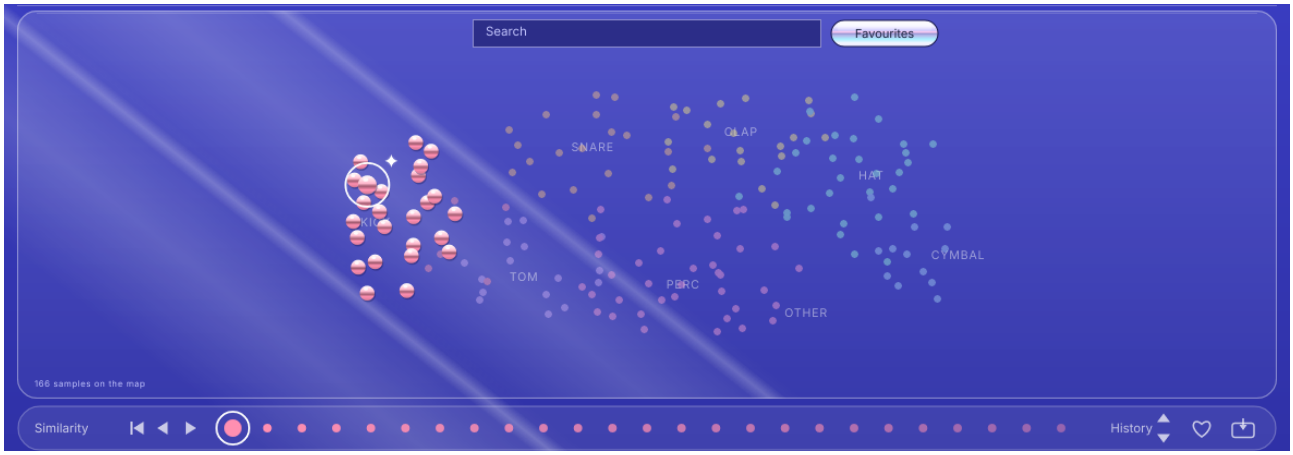
How sounds are sorted. File and folder names come first (“kick”, “BD_01”, “Snares/...”). When a name gives no hint, StretchKit listens to the sound itself: low-end energy, brightness, noisiness, decay time and the multiple bursts of a clap. Inside each group, similar sounds are placed close together.

Do this	To
Click a dot	Listen, and show its similar sounds in the similarity bar
Click and drag across the map	Hear every sound you pass over
Keep dragging out of the map onto a track	Load the last sound you heard on that track
Double-click a dot	Load it on the selected track
Mouse wheel / trackpad pinch	Zoom in and out
Two-finger scroll, Cmd-drag or right-drag	Move around (double-click empty space to reset)
Search box / Favourites	Show only names containing your words / only hearted sounds
Category buttons at the top	Show or hide that category

> You can also drag audio files straight from Finder / Explorer onto a track.

09 Similarity bar

The strip under the map shows the sound you picked (big ring) and the 24 sounds that are closest to it, nearest first. The same dots light up on the map.



Control	What it does
|< < >	Back to the picked sound / previous / play the similar sounds one after another (press again to stop)
A dot	Click to hear it; drag it onto a track to load it
History	Go back and forward through the sounds you picked before
Heart	Mark the sound as a favourite (saved). Use **Favourites** above the map to show only these
Load	Put the sound on the selected track and play it

10 Drum time-stretch

LENGTH % sets each track's length relative to the **original sample**: 50% is half as long, 200% twice as long (range 25–400%, double-click for 100%). **PITCH** tunes the sample in semitones (±24); LENGTH % still refers to the original length, so you can tune and stretch independently.

Mode	What it does	Best for
Hybrid (default)	Keeps the attack exactly as recorded and stretches only the tail.	Kicks, snares, claps — anything punchy
Smooth	Stretches the whole sample with Rubber Band R3.	Long, tonal or textured sounds
Tape	Changes speed: longer = lower, shorter = higher, like a slowed record.	Lo-fi and pitched-down effects

> Stretching is calculated in the background when a sample or setting changes, so playback itself uses almost no CPU and adds no latency. When you let go of PITCH or LENGTH %, the track plays its new sound once; click the track name to hear it again. Note: with **Choke** on, a following hit on the same track cuts a long tail — turn Choke off to hear long stretches ring out in a pattern.

11 Step sequencer

Do this	To
Click a step	Turn it on / off
Right-click or Shift-click	Make it an accent (louder, marked with a highlight)
Click and drag across steps	Paint several at once

Control	What it does
Play / Stop	Runs the sequencer when the DAW is stopped. When the DAW plays, StretchKit follows it (button shows Host).
BPM	Tempo for the internal clock; the DAW's tempo is used whenever it provides one.
Steps / Rate	Pattern length (8, 16, 32) and step size (1/8, 1/16, 1/32, 1/16 triplets).
Swing	Delays every second step for a shuffled groove.
Choke	A new hit on a track fades out the previous one. Turn off to let stretched tails ring over each other.
Master	Overall output level.
Drag MIDI	Drag onto a MIDI track in your DAW to get the pattern as a clip.

Playing with MIDI. Notes 36–43 play tracks 1–8 (C1–G1 in most DAWs; some, such as FL Studio, call the same notes C3–G3). Velocity sets the loudness.

12 Skins

Pick a look from the **SKIN** menu at the top. Your last choice is used for new instances, and each project remembers its own skin.



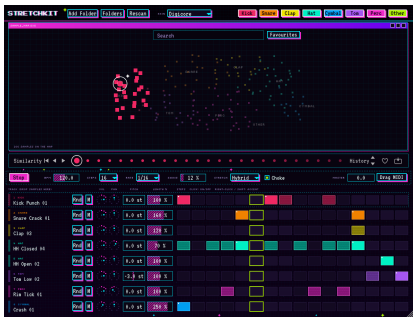
PS2 Night

Deep navy, fog, glass towers and menu lights.



Y2K Chrome

Pearl silver, chrome capsules, jelly steps.



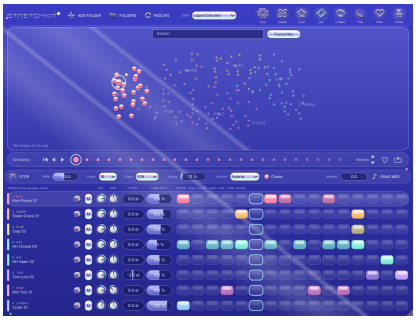
Digicore

Black and neon, pixel fonts, glitch, scanlines.



Mix

PS2 night with Y2K chrome and digicore sparkle.



Liquid Chrome

Blue-violet glass with 3D liquid-chrome icons.

13 Troubleshooting

macOS says the plugin is damaged or can't be opened.

Run the Terminal lines in Install on macOS, then restart the DAW.

StretchKit doesn't appear in my DAW.

Check the folder (section 3 or 4), make sure VST3 / AU scanning is enabled and rescan. StretchKit is an instrument, so look in the instrument list.

I hear nothing.

Press Play in the DAW or StretchKit, check that the tracks have samples and are not muted (M), and that the track's steps are on.

The map is empty.

Add a folder with Add Folder. Only one-shots up to 10 seconds in WAV / AIFF / FLAC / OGG are included. Scan progress is shown bottom-left.

I closed the plugin while it was scanning.

Nothing is lost. The scan continues by itself the next time StretchKit opens, starting where it stopped.

LENGTH or PITCH doesn't seem to change anything.

Click the track name: it plays the track's own sound. In a pattern, Choke cuts long tails when the next hit comes — turn it off to hear them.

A track says “(missing)”.

The file was moved or renamed. Load it again from the map or press Rescan.

A sound is in the wrong category.

Names win: renaming the file or its folder (e.g. adding “kick”) and pressing Rescan fixes it.

Windows warns about the standalone app.

Click More info › Run anyway. The app is unsigned, which is normal for free plugins.

14 Licence & credits

StretchKit is free and open source under the **GNU General Public License v3**. Source code: https://github.com/edwina9195/stretchkit

Built with **JUCE 8** (used under AGPLv3) and the **Rubber Band Library** by Particular Programs Ltd. (GPLv2 or later). Fonts: Rajdhani, Michroma, VT323, Silkscreen, Press Start 2P and Inter (SIL Open Font License).

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